write any more. Nowadays, with nearly everyone owning a cellphone and almost every phone incorporating a camera, people ask only for photographs.

You always try to oblige, to agree to every request, but there is never enough time to please everyone, and sometimes situations can get out of control, especially if I happen to be with my family. I have watched leading Indian players responding to constant requests by saying 'not now' and turning the other way, but I find the best strategy is to keep walking while assisting as many people as possible; in that way, hopefully, no one is offended.

The ninth season of IPL cricket was launched in April 2016 with the novel introduction of LED stumps that light up when they are broken by the ball, and the debuts of two new franchises, Gujarat Lions and Rising Pune Supergiants, created to replace two former champion teams, Chennai Super Kings and Rajasthan Royals, both of which were suspended for two seasons by the BCCI following charges of spot-fixing and betting.

I have no knowledge of either of these cases, but there is no question corruption continues to cast a shadow over our game. It's probably a fact of human nature that where there is money to be made, there will always be those prepared to go to any lengths to pocket some for themselves. The International Cricket Council, in tandem with the national bodies, has set up proper systems and structures to investigate any events that appear unusual, but it must be hard to catch players who may be collaborating with syndicates betting on, for example, things as obscure as how many runs are scored between the 17th and 26th overs of any given ODI innings.

I have never seen any indication of match-fixing and, if I did, I would report it immediately. I hate it. I really hate to think that cricketers playing with or against me could be deliberately distorting the course of the game for their own financial gain. I simply can't understand it.